

modular.html

```

1  <!DOCTYPE HTML>
2  <html>
3  <head>
4    <meta charset="UTF-8">
5    <title>Underscore Template - RequireJS sample</title>
6  </head>
7  <body>
8    <h1>Underscore.js Templates and RequireJS</h1>
9    <script src="jquery-2.1.3.min.js"></script>
10   <script src="underscore-min.js"></script>
11   <script src="require.js"></script>
12   <script type="text/javascript">
13     require.config( {
14       paths: {
15         'text' : 'text',
16       },
17       baseUrl: ''
18     });
19     var stuData = {
20       listTitle: "Students Details",
21       listItems: [
22         {
23           name: "Kavi", mark: 89
24         },
25         {
26           name: "Aarthi", mark: 78
27         },
28         {
29           name: "Bala", mark: 15
30         },
31         {
32           name: "Shrini", mark: 45
33         }
34       ]
35     };
36     $( document ).ready(function() {
37       $("#show").click(function(){
38         require(['text!stuTemplate.html'],
39           function(stuTemplate) {
40             _.templateSettings.variable = "x";
41             var template = _.template(stuTemplate);
42             var tplString = template( stuData );
43             $("#students").html(tplString);
44           }
45         );
46       });
47     });
48   </script>
49   <button id="show" type="button">Get Student Details</button>
50   <div id="students"> </div>
51 </body>
52 </html>

```

Keep the template file as *stuTemplate.html*.

```

<h2> <%- x.listTitle %> </h2>
<ul>
  <% _.each( x.listItems, function( listItem ){ %>
    <li>
      <%- listItem.name %>
      <% if { listItem.mark >30 }{ %>
        <em>Pass</em>
      <% else { %>
        <em>Fail</em>
      <%>
    </li>
  <% } }> %>
</ul>

```

modular.html: An explanation

- Lines 13-18 define some basic settings for Require.js. They define the plugin name *text.js* and base URL of the library or text files.
- When the execution reaches Line 38, it fetches the contents of *stuTemplate.html* and assigns it into the variable *stuTemplate*.

Open *modular.html* in a browser. You will notice that the template file has not loaded on initial page load. Click the button *Get Student details*. Require.js will make the AJAX request fetch the template file contents.

Advantages of Underscore.js

- The main advantage of the Underscore template is its simplicity. You don't need to learn any new syntax. If you know JavaScript coding, you can directly start using this.
 - The precompilation option improves the performance of the code.
 - We can also use other Underscore functions.
 - It is a default template engine for BackboneJS, and it is easy to make it modular by using RequireJS.
- If you want to keep your client-side code clean without much effort, try the Underscore.js template.

You can get the working sample codes shown in this article from https://github.com/kbalavignesh/undertemplate_sample 

References

- <http://underscorejs.org/>
- <http://underscorejs.org/#template>
- <http://requirejs.org/>
- <http://www.2ality.com/2012/06/underscore-templates.html>

By: Bala Vignesh Kasinathan

The author has over 10 years of experience in Web and mobile applications development with open source technologies. Presently, he works for CGI. You can reach him at kbalavignesh@gmail.com